

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣10

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2NT

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣4

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦3

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♠J

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣5

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 5 3

♥ 8

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ Q 7 3

♠ K 8 6

♥ A 9 3

♦ K Q 8

♣ A K J 2



♠ A Q 2

♥ 10 6

♦ 6 5 4

♣ 10 8 6 5 4

♠ 7 4

♥ K Q J 7 5 4 2

♦ A 9 2

♣ 9

After NORTH opens 2NT, SOUTH is pretty sure there will be a slam in ♥s. But, the contract should be played from the NORTH side so the opening lead doesn't go through any vulnerable ♠ holding NORTH might have.

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♥s, then uses Blackwood to be sure they aren't off two Aces. Missing one Ace he settles for 6♥.

West	North	East	South
	2NT	Pass	3♦
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♣10			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 9 8 5

♥ Q 7

♦ K 8 7

♣ J 9 6 5

♠ Q 7 4 3

♥ A 9 4

♦ Q 9 3

♣ A Q 3



♠ A 6

♥ K J 5 3

♦ A 6 5 4

♣ K 10 7

♠ J 10 2

♥ 10 8 6 2

♦ J 10 2

♣ 8 4 2

WEST has an invitational hand, (9 points), after EAST's 1NT opening. With a 4-card ♠ suit she uses Stayman.

EAST then shows his 4-card ♥ suit.

With no ♥ fit, WEST can only invite with 2NT, an invitation which EAST declines.

*West**North**East**South*

2♣

Pass

2♥

Pass

2NT

All Pass

2NT by East

Lead: ♣4

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 3
 ♥ 10 9 8 2
 ♦ 9 6 3
 ♣ K 3 2

♠ A 7 5

♥ Q J 6

♦ A K 5 2

♣ Q 10 9



♠ 10 2

♥ 7 4

♦ Q 10 7 4

♣ A J 8 7 5

♠ K 9 8 6 4

♥ A K 5 3

♦ J 8

♣ 6 4

Because SOUTH holds a 4-card Major suit, (♥s), he starts his responses with Stayman.

NORTH denies holding any 4-card Major suit so SOUTH gives up on ♥s. He next bids ♠s, showing five of them. He jumps to 3♠, giving NORTH the choice between 4♠ or 3NT.

With three trumps NORTH chooses 4♠.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♦	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♦3			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A K 7 3

♥ Q J 2

♦ J 5

♣ K Q J 6

♠ J 9

♥ A 10 8 5

♦ K 10 8 7

♣ A 10 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 6 5

♥ K 7 6 4

♦ A 3 2

♣ 5 4

♠ 10 4 2

♥ 9 3

♦ Q 9 6 4

♣ 9 8 7 2

EAST has a poor 9 points, but does have two 4-card Majors. So he uses Stayman.

When WEST bids ♠s, EAST isn't strong enough to bid game herself, so she temporizes with a 3♠ invitation.

WEST has a full 17 points so he accepts the invitation.

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♠	Pass	3♠	Pass
4♠			
All Pass			
4♠ by West			
Lead: ♠J			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 3 2
 ♥ K J
 ♦ J 8 4
 ♣ A K 9 6 3

♠ K Q
 ♥ A Q 7 5
 ♦ K 10 9
 ♣ Q J 8 4



♠ 9 4
 ♥ 10 8 6 4 3 2
 ♦ 7 6 3 2
 ♣ 5

♠ J 10 8 7 6 5
 ♥ 9
 ♦ A Q 5
 ♣ 10 7 2

SOUTH, with 9 points and a 6-card suit, knows they should play in ♠s. The question is: how high?

SOUTH transfers NORTH to ♠s, then invites by raising to 3♠.

NORTH has only two trumps, (good ones, admittedly), but she has a maximum 17 point hand. So she bids the ♠ game.

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♣5			